

Samagra launches a GovTech mentoring course

Samagra, an India governance consulting firm, has launched ‘Code for GovTech’ — an open source GovTech mentoring programme for engineering students (C4GT). This summer coding programme will run from May to August 2022, and one can apply through Samagra’s official website. Those selected as contributors will also receive a stipend and a job opportunity with prominent GovTech firms, according to the firm.

Students will be able to learn from and interact with GovTech practitioners both inside and outside the government as part of the programme. They will also receive hands-on 1:1 mentoring from ecosystem pioneers such as EkStep, Tekdi, NavaDhiti, and others. The C4GT will be held on GitHub.



Commenting on the C4GT launch, Gaurav Goel, CEO and founder, Samagra, stated, “In a country of more than 130 crore citizens, the importance of technology in ensuring last-mile delivery of public services in a standardised manner cannot be underestimated. The role of GovTech in solving the pressing governance challenges of our times is only going to increase. And therefore, there is a need for the best engineering talent in the country to become a part of and lead the next wave of GovTech innovation. Code for GovTech has been designed as a way to create a tech talent pipeline which can solve some of the most complex challenges facing India.”

Nonetheless, Atom is expected to operate past its December 15, 2022 decommissioning date. GitHub intends to archive the Atom repository, but the code is open source and available to anyone who wants to champion the project.

Credentials of thousands of open source projects are at risk

Thousands of authentication tokens and other security-sensitive secrets are being leaked by a service that assists open source developers in writing and testing software. According to a new report by security experts, many of these leaks allow hackers to access the private accounts of developers on GitHub, Docker, AWS, and other code repositories.



The availability of Travis CI’s third-party developer credentials has been an ongoing issue since at least 2015. HackerOne, a security vulnerability service, reported at the time that a GitHub account it used had been compromised after the service exposed an access token for one of the HackerOne developers. A similar leak surfaced in 2019 and again last year.

Anyone who has access to the tokens can read or modify the code stored in repositories that distribute an uncountable number of ongoing software applications and code libraries. The ability to gain unauthorised access to such projects opens the door to supply chain attacks, which involve threat actors tampering with malware before it is distributed to users. The attackers can use their ability to modify the app to target a large number of projects that rely on it in production servers.

Despite the fact that this is a known security risk, researchers from the Aqua Security firm’s Nautilus team report that leaks have continued. A series of two batches of data accessed by the researchers using the Travis CI programming interface yielded 4.28 million and 770 million logs from 2013 to May 2022, respectively. The researchers discovered 73,000 tokens, secrets, and various credentials after sampling a small percentage of the data.

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